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Motion Problems

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Motion Problems

Motion problems use the formula $r \times t = d$, or $rate \times time = distance$.
Let's see how the formula works.

Example 1

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Imagine you drove 60 miles per hour for two hours. How many miles did you drive?

The rate is 60 miles per hour. The time is 2 hours. Use the formula: $60 \times 2 = 120$ The distance traveled is **120 miles**.

Example 2

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Two trains leave a station at the same time. One heads west at an average speed of 75 miles per hour, and the other heads east at an average speed of 60 miles per hour. How far apart will the trains be at the end of 2 hours?

Step 1

Draw a diagram to help you picture what is happening in the problem. The trains are going in opposite directions. The distance apart is the sum of the distances.



Step 2

Write and solve an equation.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{train 1} + \text{train 2} &= \text{distance apart} \\ (75 \times 2) + (60 \times 2) &= d \\ 150 + 120 &= 270 \text{ miles} \end{aligned}$$

After 2 hours, the trains will be **270 miles apart**.



Tip

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Lesson 6: Common Algebra
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